Kashmir. The blame is traditionally placed at the door of P.N. Haksar, who believed that more humiliating terms for Pakistan would have been akin to the 1914 Versailles Treaty for Germany and would therefore have perpetuated grievances and conflict. [17] Other considerations were also at play, including international sentiment. Many countries believed that India had already achieved an absolute victory in the dismemberment of Pakistan and creation of Bangladesh and were less sympathetic to further Indian demands. Moreover, rather than a bargaining chip, the Pakistani prisoners of war proved something of a liability and India (and Bangladesh) were keen to get rid of them.

Subsequent events made things even more difficult. On the one hand, India began to return prisoners in September 1973, Pakistan recognized Bangladesh in 1974, and India and Pakistan re-established full diplomatic ties in 1976. However, India's Peaceful Nuclear Explosion of 1974, Sheikh Abdullah's return to power as chief minister in Jammu and Kashmir, and the Indian annexation of Sikkim further decreased the appetite in Pakistan for normalization. Strangely, India–Pakistan relations initially improved following the coup that brought General Zia ul-Haq to power in Pakistan. Cricketing ties were re-established, consulates in Karachi and Bombay were opened, and an agreement was finalized for a hydroelectric dam in India over the Chenab River. India's External Affairs Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee visited Pakistan in 1978, having already visited the other South Asian capitals, and India allowed Pakistan to enter the Non-Aligned Movement in 1979. [18]

The 1980s brought an end to this nascent bonhomie. The Soviet war in Afghanistan brought India and Pakistan on to opposite sides of a Cold War hotspot. India blocked Pakistan's re-entry to the Commonwealth. Meanwhile, as Zia faced popular protests in Sindh, Balochistan and the North-West Frontier Province (NWFP, now Khyber–Pakhtunkhwa), Indira Gandhi spoke up for democratic forces in Pakistan. India's concerns about Pakistan's nuclear programme also increased, as well as Pakistani concerns about a possible Indian strike on its Kahuta reactor. In 1984, India pre-emptively occupied the Siachen Glacier at an altitude extending to over